# UnTangle

**A Gen-Z Mental Health Companion**

**Medha Pendyala**

**DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL- Warangal**

**XI MEC**

## Abstract:-

**In a generation marked by social isolation, digital fatigue, and academic pressure,**

**mental health awareness is no longer optional — it's essential.**

**Teenage mental health isn't just fragile—**

**it's often forgotten,more than a concern;**

**it's become a crisis.**

**While adult and family therapy services are slowly expanding across India, there remains a visible and urgent gap when it comes to addressing the emotional needs of students.Despite the growing awareness, their struggles are often dismissed,overlooked or misunderstood.**

**This paper explores the real, raw mental health challenges faced by teenagers today-identifying the existing gaps in support systems and highlights the lack of relatable, accessible care designed for them,**

**To address this,it proposes Untangle —**

**A digital platform built with Gen-Z in mind,**

**a space for self guided healing, combining**

**task based therapy,mood tracking, and access to verified mental health support, all through a digitally native experience inspired by evidence-based therapeutic practices.**

**Designed by students, for students.**

**Untangle aims to create a mental health space that feels safe, familiar, and judgment-free for students.A companion for mental wellbeing in a world that often doesn't listen**

**This paper outlines the problem, solution design, market potential, user experience, monetization strategy, and a future roadmap — aiming to position Untangle as a commercially scalable and socially transformative mental health solution.**

# 1. Introduction:

# The Silent Crisis – Mental Health Awareness in India

**Mental health — a subject once brushed under the rug — is finally being recognized as a cornerstone of human well-being.**

**Today, we stand at the turning point. Global bodies like the The World Health Organization reveal that 1 in 7 adolescents experience a mental disorder, yet over 80% don't seek help due to stigma,cost, or lack of relatable platforms**

**In India, although conversations about therapy are growing louder, most existing platforms largely remain adult-centric, either focusing on family counselling or clinical therapy whereas,Teenagers remain unseen — their struggles normalized as "just a phase." Due to the lack of accessible, relatable, and affordable mental health solutions for students, many young minds are forced to carry more than they should — alone.**

**This isn't just a gap; it's a crisis.**

**And it's time we named it — a silent crisis that continues to be perpetuated.**

**Why awareness matters:**

- **Only 29% of Indian adolescents with mental health issues receive help.**
- **Suicide is the leading cause of death among Indian youth aged 15–29.**
- **Lack of awareness leads to delayed treatment, poor academic performance, and long-term emotional scarring.**

# 2. Problem Statement

- **Students face unique pressures: exam stress, peer comparison, identity confusion, trauma, parental pressure, heartbreak, and screen addiction.**
- **Most platforms are either too clinical or adult-focused.**
- **Access to counselors is limited, especially in tier-2/3 cities.**
- **Teenagers prefer chat-based, task-driven, aesthetic, and judgment-free spaces, which current platforms lack**

**Research Findings**

- **85% of students (survey of 60+) said they don't feel comfortable going to real-life counselors.**
- **Students prefer activity-based, self-guided emotional tools they can use privately.**
- **The majority want an app or site with:**
    - **Mood tracking**
    - **Calming visuals**
    - **Language they relate to (English, GENZ )**
    - **Custom tasks like journaling, breathing, artistic expression**

**Student voices reveal common pain points:**

- **"I don't know how to explain what I'm feeling."**
- **"I don't want to be called overdramatic."**
- **"Even if I know therapy exists, I can't afford it or access it."**

**There's a need for a space designed by a student, for students.**

WILL ADD THE SURVEY INFORMATION******

# 3. Solution: Untangle – A Gen-Z Mental Health Companion

## Vision:

**To build a digital-first emotional support platform where students feel understood, guided, and supported — without fear, judgment, or overwhelm.**

## Core Features:

| Feature Name | What It Does | Why It Matters (Impact) |
|---|---|---|
| **Emotion-Based Prompt Selector** | Users choose how they feel (e.g., anxious, heavy) via mood tags or emojis. | Creates an emotionally personalized experience from the first screen. |
| **Concern Chooser** | Lets users pick specific real-life issues they relate to. | Increases relatability and builds trust; filters healing paths accordingly. |
| **Therapeutic Task Engine (CBT/DBT)** | Offers 1–3 bite-sized coping tasks per concern (e.g., grounding, reframing). | Provides effective, research-backed healing without overwhelming the user. |
| **Mini Journal & Prompts** | Private journaling space with short emotional prompts. | Encourages reflection and emotional release in a non-intimidating way. |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Mood Music & Audio Tools** | Calming/energizing music and audio meditations tailored to the mood. | Enhances emotional regulation using sound-based therapy. |
| **Vision Board / Digital Collage** | Users can create digital mood boards with images, quotes, affirmations. | Fosters creativity and self-expression as a therapeutic outlet. |
| **MindKit – Healing Toolkit** | Central space to save favorite tools, journals, music, and coping routines. | Builds a personal emotional survival kit over time. |
| **Mood Tracker** | Tracks mood patterns over time via emojis, tags, or color scales. | Promotes self-awareness and helps users identify emotional trends. |
| **Growth & Improvement Tracker** | Visual tracker that maps healing journey—what helped, when, and how. | Shows tangible progress and builds self-belief; reinforces healthy behaviors. |
| **Streaks & Rewards (Optional)** | Encourages daily engagement with badges, affirmations, or kind reminders. | Builds consistent habits in a gentle, pressure-free way. |
| **Reminder System** | Sends emotional check-ins and supportive nudges. | Keeps the user gently engaged in healing without judgment. |
| **Panic Button / SOS** | Directs users to helplines, nearby therapists, and instant grounding tools. | Offers urgent support during emotional crises. |
| **Period & Hormonal Tracker** | Syncs emotional tracking with menstrual/hormonal cycles .( female users) | Brings body-mind awareness and supports mood understanding. |

# 4**.PROBLEM MATRIX**

# Top Mental Health Concerns Among Students

**These are the most commonly reported emotional challenges, especially for Gen Z students — sourced from studies, and counseling reports from India.**

| Category | Common Concern (Student Language) |
|---|---|

| | |
|---|---|
| **Anxiety/ Overthinking** | **“I can’t stop overthinking”** |
| **Emotional Numbness** | **“I feel numb or tired all the time”** |
| **Fear of Failure** | **“I’m scared I’ll fail”** |
| **Low Self Esteem** | **“I feel left out or not good enough”** |
| **Peer Pressure** | **“I’m scared of disappointing my parents”** |
| **Relationship Issues** | **“They ghosted me and I don’t know why”** |
| **Academic Burnout** | **“I’m mentally exhausted from studying”** |
| **Loneliness** | **“ I feel alone even when surrounded by people.”** |
| **Mood Swings** | **“My emotions change rapidly and unpredictably”** |

# 5. Activities / Solutions for Each Concern — With Explanation

**These tasks are real, research-backed, non-triggering, and designed to be self-led. Every activity comes with a reason so users know why it helps.**

## Why These Work:

- **Every task based on CBT (Cognitive Behavioral Therapy), DBT (Dialectical Behavior Therapy), and mindfulness therapy principles**
- **Research-backed techniques converted into Gen-Z friendly activities.**
- **Safe, private space to begin emotional healing.**
- **Examples:**
    - **CBT: Challenging unhelpful thoughts through reflection.**
    - **Mindfulness: Breath focus, body scan journaling.**
    - **DBT: Emotion regulation through creative expression.**
- **Designed for teens: short, interactive, visually guided.**
- **Emotion-focused not diagnosis-based: makes it safe, comforting, and non-judgmental.**
- **All activities are: Self-led ,Private -Emotionally gentle**

****

| Category | Student Phrase | Top 5 Tasks (Ranked) | Why It Works (CBT/DBT Backing) |
|---|---|---|---|

| Anxiety / Overthinking | “I can’t stop overthinking” | 1. 3 Facts  + 1 Fear 2. Mind Dumping 3. Box Breathing 4. Worry Time Scheduling 5. 5-4-3-2-1 Grounding | CBT: 3 Facts + 1 Fear helps replace distorted thinking with logic.Journaling (Mind Dumping): Offloads spiraling thoughts. Box Breathing: Activates parasympathetic nervous system. Worry Time: CBT tactic to delay intrusive thoughts. Grounding: Anchors attention to the present moment. | | --- | --- | --- | --- |

| Emotional Numbness | “I feel numb or tired all the time” | 1. Opposite Action (DBT) 2. Cold Water Splash / Ice Hold 3. Emotion Wheel Check-In 4. Sensory Activation Task 5. Structured Mini-Goal Task | DBT Opposite Action: Engages in mood-shifting behavior (movement, expression). Ice Splash: Triggers vagus nerve, waking up emotional centers. Emotion Check-in: Helps recognize subtle feelings. Sensory Task: Stimulates neural arousal.Mini-Goal: Builds small wins for dopamine release. | | --- | --- | --- | --- |

| Fear of Failure | “I’m scared I’ll fail” | 1. Evidence For vs. Against Thought 2. Future Self Visualization 3. Setbacks to Comeback Timeline 4. Success Log 5. Fear Ladder | CBT Thought Challenge: Teaches cognitive restructuring. Future Visualization: Motivates by purpose. Comeback Timeline: Reframes failure as redirection.Success Log: Reinforces capability. Fear Ladder: Gradual exposure reduces performance avoidance. | | --- | --- | --- | --- |

| Low Self Esteem | “I feel left out or not good enough” | 1. Mirror Affirmation + Proof 2. Self-Compassion Letter3. Strength-Based Reframing 4. Compliment Tracker 5. “I Am” Identity Tree | CBT: Builds new core beliefs via real evidence. Self-Compassion: Uses DBT’s radical acceptance. Strength Reframing: Shifts focus from deficits to assets. Compliment Tracker: Reinforces external validation. Identity Tree: Connects with inner self through affirming traits. | | --- | --- | --- | --- |

| Peer Pressure / Parental Pressure | “I’m scared of disappointing my parents” | 1. Values Clarification Worksheet2. Wise Mind Exercise (DBT) 3. Assertive Communication Practice 4. “Not My Thought” Distancing 5. Role Reversal Reflection | CBT Values Work: Differentiates self from imposed expectations. Wise Mind: Blends emotion + logic. Assertiveness Training: Builds boundary setting. Thought Distancing: Helps detach from parental internalized voice. Role Reversal: Builds empathy and repositions guilt. | | --- | --- | --- | --- |

| Relationship Issues | “They ghosted me and I don’t know why” | 1. Radical Acceptance (DBT) 2. Unsent Letter Technique 3. Thought Diffusion (ACT technique) 4. Red Flag Reflection Task 5. Self-Soothe Box | DBT: Acceptance without needing closure. Letter Writing: Emotional ventilation and closure. Thought Diffusion: Disempowers obsessive loops. Red Flag Reflection: Prevents future harm. Self-Soothe: Uses sensory calming to heal abandonment hurt. | | --- | --- | --- | --- |

| Academic Burnout | “I’m mentally exhausted from studying” | 1. Pomodoro + Reward System 2. Energy Pie Chart 3. Self-Care Menu 4. “Not To-Do” List 5. Academic Wins Journal | CBT Behavioral Activation: Encourages rest-work balance. Pie Chart: Visualizes imbalance in energy drain. Self-Care Menu: Prevents exhaustion via choice. Not-To-Do List: Declutters obligations. Wins Journal: Restores academic identity. | | --- | --- | --- | --- |

| Loneliness | “I feel alone even when surrounded by people.” | 1. Scheduled Connection Task 2. Gratitude Photo Journal 3. Interest-Based Group Hunt 4. Letter to Future Friend 5. Pet/Nature Interaction | DBT Skill BUILDING: Encourages social skill practice. Gratitude Task: Enhances oxytocin + belonging. Group Hunt: Builds tribe from shared interest. Future Friend Letter: Creates hope. Pet/Nature: Boosts serotonin through non-judgmental interaction. | | --- | --- | --- | --- |

| Mood Swings | “My emotions change rapidly and unpredictably” | 1. Emotion Tracker Log 2. DBT Check the Facts 3. STOP Skill (DBT) 4. Trigger Journal 5. Music + Mood Sync Task | Emotion Tracker: Increases emotional literacy. DBT “Check the Facts”: Helps see reality beyond emotion. STOP Skill: Delays impulsive reaction. Trigger Journal: Builds patterns for regulation. Music Sync: Affects affective state + catharsis. | | --- | --- | --- | --- |

**What’s Done in the Task**

---

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Anxiety / Overthinking** | **“I can’t stop overthinking”** | **3 Facts + 1 Fear** | **Replaces irrational thoughts with facts (CBT cognitive restructuring)** | **Write 3 facts that contradict your worry + 1 fear to acknowledge it. Example: "I'm prepared for the test. I've revised twice. I have notes. I'm scared I’ll blank out."** |
| | | **Mind Dumping** | **Clears cluttered thoughts (CBT journaling technique)** | **Set a timer (5–10 mins). Write *everything* on your mind, unfiltered. Don’t read or judge it. Close the notebook when time’s up.** |
| | | **Box Breathing** | **Calms the nervous system** | **Inhale 4 secs → hold 4 secs → exhale 4** |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | (breathing therapy + DBT distress tolerance) | secs → hold 4 secs. Repeat 4–5 rounds. |
| | | Worry Time Scheduling | Contain worries instead of suppressing them | Pick a 15-minute window daily. Postpone every worry until then. Only worry in that time. This tricks the brain into control. |
| | | 5-4-3-2-1 Grounding | Anchors attention to the present moment | Name: 5 things you see → 4 things you feel → 3 sounds → 2 smells → 1 taste. Use all senses. |
| Emotional Numbness | "I feel numb or tired all the time" | Opposite Action | Breaks inactivity loops by doing opposite of what you feel (DBT) | If you feel like lying down → go for a brisk walk. If you feel like shutting down → call someone or sing aloud. |
| | | Ice Hold / Cold Water Splash | Activates vagus nerve and increases emotional arousal | Hold an ice cube or splash cold water on your face. Stay with the sensation mindfully. |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Emotion Wheel Check-In | Helps label subtle or buried emotions | Look at an emotion wheel. Pick the closest word to what you feel (not just “fine” or “okay”). |
| | | Sensory Activation Task | Stimulates underactive sensory system | Choose a strong scent (lemon, peppermint), touch (velvet, clay), or music. Focus only on that one sensation for 3–5 minutes. |
| | | Structured Mini-Goal Task | Provides dopamine hits through success | Choose a 5-min goal: tidy desk, drink water, take one note page. Celebrate when done. |
| Fear of Failure | “I’m scared I’ll fail” | Evidence For vs. Against Thought | Disproves irrational fears by writing real-life proof (CBT thought record) | Write your fear. List 3 pieces of evidence for it and 3 pieces against it. Reframe with a more realistic thought. |
| | | Future Self Visualization | Boosts purpose and self-efficacy | Close eyes. Imagine your confident future self (1 |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | year later). What are they doing? What do they thank you for? |
| | | Setbacks to Comeback Timeline | Reframes failure as part of growth | List past setbacks → write how you bounced back or what it taught you. Make it visual like a timeline or a ladder. |
| | | Success Log | Builds self-confidence and proof of wins | Every day/week, write 1 small success—even if it's "I woke up on time" or "I revised one page." |
| | | Fear Ladder | Reduces avoidance through graded exposure | List what you fear most → break into smaller, doable steps → climb the ladder one step at a time. |
| Low Self Esteem | "I feel left out or not good enough" | Mirror Affirmation + Proof | Changes negative self-image by combining affirmations with evidence | Say: "I am kind" → write down 1–2 times you showed kindness. Do this with 3 traits daily. |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Self-Compassion Letter | Builds emotional safety and warmth inside (DBT radical acceptance) | Write a letter to yourself as if from a loving friend. Include comfort, understanding, and hope. |
| | | Strength-Based Reframing | Focuses on capabilities instead of flaws | List something you think is a weakness. Reframe it as a strength in a different context. E.g., "Too sensitive" → "Empathetic & aware." |
| | | Compliment Tracker | Collects external proof of worth | Write down 1 compliment you got each day. Read them back weekly. |
| | | "I Am" Identity Tree | Connects with core self and personal identity | Draw a tree. Roots = your values, trunk = your strengths, branches = your dreams, leaves = traits others admire in you. |
| Parental / Peer Pressure | "I'm scared of disappointing my parents" | Values Clarification Worksheet | Aligns decisions with inner compass instead of external pressure | List 5 values that matter most to you. For each: How can you live it today? How is |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | | it different from what others want for you? |
| Wise Mind Exercise (DBT) | Integrates logic + emotion | Ask: “What would my emotional mind say?” → “What would my logical mind say?” → “What’s the wise decision between the two?” |
| Assertive Communicatio n Practice | Helps speak up clearly and respectfully | Practice saying no or expressing needs using “I feel… I need…” structure. Role-play with a peer or mirror. |
| Not My Thought | Detaches from internalized beliefs | Write down the stressful thought (“I must top”). Say: “This is a thought I learned. It’s not who I am.” |
| Role Reversal Reflection | Rebuilds empathy and understanding | Write what your parent/friend might be thinking or feeling. Then respond from |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | your side with clarity. |
| Relationship Issues | “They ghosted me and I don’t know why” | Radical Acceptance | Heals from the need for closure or fairness (DBT core skill) | Say out loud: “I don’t like this, but I accept that I cannot change it. I choose to focus on my healing now.” |
| | | Unsent Letter Technique | Allows release without contact | Write everything you want to say to them. Don’t send it. Tear, burn, or save. |
| | | Thought Diffusion | Separates self from negative thoughts | When a thought hits (“I wasn’t enough”), say: “I’m having the thought that…” and repeat it in a silly voice or sing it out. |
| | | Red Flag Reflection Task | Builds awareness of toxic patterns | List signs you ignored → what did they cost you? → what will you look out for next time? |
| | | Self-Soothe Box | Provides safe emotional relief | Create a box (real or digital) with: a scent you love, a soft object, a |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | comforting playlist, favorite quote/image. |
| Academic Burnout | "I'm mentally exhausted from studying" | Pomodoro + Reward | Prevents exhaustion through rest + motivation | 25 min study → 5 min break → 4 rounds = 1 long break. Add a small reward after completing a session. |
| | | Energy Pie Chart | Shows where mental energy is leaking | Draw a pie chart of where your energy goes in a week: school, phone, chores, friends. Reflect and adjust. |
| | | Self-Care Menu | Builds a go-to list of refreshing choices | Make a list of quick self-care options in 5 min, 15 min, and 1 hour categories. Choose one during breaks. |
| | | "Not To-Do" List | Clears unnecessary obligations | List 3 things you need to stop doing (e.g., scrolling late at night, comparing, taking up others' stress). |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Academic Wins Journal | Reinforces progress and ability | Write 1 thing you did right academically every day, no matter how small. |
| Loneliness | “I feel alone even when surrounded by people.” | Scheduled Connection Task | Boosts social interaction on purpose | Pick one person to message or talk to each day. Schedule it like a habit. |
| | | Gratitude Photo Journal | Builds connection through appreciation | Take one photo daily of something that made you feel thankful. Create a digital or printed collage. |
| | | Interest-Based Group Hunt | Creates belonging through shared identity | Search for a club, community, or group (online or offline) around your interest. Join or observe silently. |
| | | Letter to Future Friend | Promotes hope and openness | Write to a friend you haven’t met yet. Describe what you’ll do together, what they’ll love about you. |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Pet/Nature Interaction | Regulates emotions with non-judgmental connection | Play with a pet, visit a garden, water plants, or walk barefoot on grass. |
| Mood Swings | “My emotions change rapidly and unpredictably” | Emotion Tracker Log | Helps observe and label patterns | Rate your mood (1–10) 2–3 times a day. Write what triggered it and what helped. |
| | | DBT Check the Facts | Reduces extreme emotional thinking | Ask: “What are the facts?” “What am I feeling?” “Are they matching?” “What else could be true?” |
| | | STOP Skill (DBT) | Prevents impulsive reactions | Stop → Take a breath → Observe → Proceed wisely |
| | | Trigger Journal | Identifies what sets off emotions | Note moments you felt intense emotion. What triggered it? What did you do? What could you try next time? |
| | | Music + Mood Sync | Uses emotional catharsis and | Make 3 playlists: mood-matchin |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | **reset through music** | **g (sad for sad), mood-lifting (happy), mood-neutral (instrumentals). Listen based on emotional goal.** |

# 6. User Experience (UX): Practical, Private, and Gen Z-Aligned

**Untangle** is designed to offer a **realistic, accessible, and self-guided healing experience**. Students can privately navigate their emotions through a sequence of relatable concerns and receive instant therapeutic support—**without the need for live counselors or AI**.

**Users select what they're struggling with → get mood-appropriate therapeutic tasks → save what helps → build a personal mental health toolkit.**

---

## How It Works – User Journey

## Step 1: Onboarding

- Users can sign up or enter as a guest.
- They begin with a **light mood check-in** using a simple scale (e.g., sad, anxious, angry, low).
- The user selects how they feel, which sets the tone for the experience.

---

## Step 2: Choose a Concern Prompt

Students are presented with relatable emotional challenges (from the Problem Matrix), such as:

- "I can't stop overthinking" *(Anxiety / Overthinking)*
- "I feel numb or tired all the time" *(Emotional Numbness)*
- "I'm scared I'll fail" *(Fear of Failure)*
- "I feel left out or not good enough" *(Low Self-Esteem)*
- "I'm scared of disappointing my parents" *(Peer Pressure)*
- "They ghosted me and I don't know why" *(Relationship Issues)*
- "I'm mentally exhausted from studying" *(Academic Burnout)*
- "I feel alone even when surrounded by people" *(Loneliness)*
- "My emotions change rapidly and unpredictably" *(Mood Swings)*

---

### Step 3: Receive Your 'Untangle Activity'

Based on the concern, the app instantly recommends a **bundle of 5 core healing tasks**:

1. **Journaling Prompt** – Reflective writing tailored to the selected emotion
2. **CBT/DBT-Based Task** – Includes grounding techniques, reframing exercises, etc.
3. **Music or Audio Therapy** – Soothing tracks or energizing playlists
4. **Art-Based Expression** – Sketch, scribble, or collage-style activities
5. **Mind Exercise** – Guided breathing, 5-4-3-2-1 grounding, or box breathing

Each bundle is short, guided, and crafted for **emotional regulation** and **self-understanding**.

---

### Step 4: MindKit – Your Healing Dashboard

- Users can **save favorite tasks**, track what works, and build their own **"emotional first-aid kit."**
- Includes:
    - Mood Tracker with insights
    - streak system (low pressure)
    - Growth Bar to visualize healing progress
    - Personalized Vision Board
    - Gentle reminders for check-ins

---

### Step 5: Progress & Support

- A **Mental Health Progress Tracker** gives users a visual sense of how consistent healing practices are benefiting them.
- **SOS Panic Button** connects users to verified helplines during emotional emergencies.
- **Optional Female Health Tracker** integrates mood and cycle tracking for better emotional balance.

WILL ADD A FLOWCHART REGARDING UX

# 7. TECHNICAL IMPLEMENTATION

The app will be developed in two stages — a **no-code prototype** for initial testing, followed by a **fully coded mobile application** if scaled.

### Stage 1: No-Code Prototype (Concept Stage)

At the ideation level, we will use **no-code platforms** like **Glide**, **Thunkable**, or **Bubble.io** to build a fully functional prototype. This allows:

- Drag-and-drop interface design
- Integration of mental health prompts and journaling
- Task-based habit tracking and progress visualization
- Conditional logic to map user responses to 5 key healing tasks

This approach helps demonstrate **core user flows, functionality, and UI/UX** without requiring advanced technical skills or backend development.

### Stage 2: Full App Development (Scalable Stage)

If selected for further development, the app can be built using:

- **Frontend:** React Native (cross-platform), Flutter (UI-rich)
- **Backend:** Firebase (authentication, database, real-time storage)
- **Database:** Firestore or SQLite (for local & cloud storage)
- **APIs:** Period tracking, mental health support links, music integration
- **Gamification Layer:** Custom logic to track streaks, give rewards, and display healing progress

---

## Key Functionalities (Technical Perspective)

| Feature | Technical Approach |
|---|---|
| **Prompt Selection** | Dropdown/select menu mapped to concern prompts from problem matrix |
| **Task Assignment** | Predefined CBT/DBT activities shown based on selected concern |
| **Mood & Progress Tracker** | Stored in cloud/local database; visualized via charts or progress bars |
| **Vision Board** | Image upload or moodboard generator (local storage or cloud bucket) |
| **Streaks & Rewards** | Logic-based counters for consistency; updates based on daily check-ins |
| **SOS Button** | API linking to real-time helpline numbers and emergency chat support |
| **Period Tracker** | Prebuilt period calendar tools integrated via open APIs |

---

## Scalability & Feasibility

- Uses **low-code/no-code** tools for rapid prototyping
- Modular design to add AI features, chatbots, or advanced tracking in the future
- Can run on both Android and iOS via cross-platform tools

# 8. MARKET FEASIBILITY + IMPACT

### Target Audience

- Adolescents and young adults aged 13–22
- Especially relevant for students and youth in semi-urban and urban India who actively seek emotional support but lack structured access to therapy or professional help.

---

### Feasibility Analysis

| Factor | Details |
|---|---|
| **Digital Native Generation** | Youth today are hyper-connected, app-friendly, and already engaging in emotional content. |
| **Tech Readiness** | Can be built on no-code or low-code platforms (e.g. Glide, Bubble) or scaled via custom development. |
| **Cost Efficiency** | Minimal cost in early stages due to prompt-based design, self-guided structure, and no need for AI or live support. |
| **Low Competition in Niche** | Existing apps often focus on therapy, meditation, or AI bots. Untangle is task-based, habit-forming, and built for everyday emotional hygiene. |
| **Pilot-Ready** | Easily piloted in schools or youth communities without requiring therapists or heavy infrastructure. |
| **Data-Backed Relevance** | WHO reports that 1 in 7 adolescents face mental health issues. There is a clear unmet need. |

---

### Scalability and Growth Potential

Untangle has potential far beyond institutional adoption:

- **Beyond Schools:** The app is designed for daily, independent use—becoming a self-healing companion, not just a school tool.
- **Modular Design:** Features like mood trackers, emotion prompts, vision boards, and habit streaks can evolve with user trends and needs.
- **Future Upgrades:** Potential to integrate AI-generated suggestions, journaling companions, or safe community spaces in later stages.

---

### Projected Impact

| Area | Impact Description |
|---|---|
| **Emotional Literacy** | Users regularly engage in guided reflection, improving awareness of thoughts and feelings. |
| **Mental Health Access** | Democratizes access to coping tools without stigma or clinical diagnosis requirements. |
| **Healthy Habits** | Streaks, task rewards, and gamification promote consistency and emotional discipline. |
| **Resilience and Agency** | Helps youth build personal toolkits to regulate emotions and develop a growth mindset. |
| **Privacy and Safety** | Completely self-paced and anonymous—respects emotional boundaries and user safety. |

---

### Vision Forward

Untangle is not just an app — it is a youth-first emotional empowerment platform that can become:

- A daily ritual for emotional wellness
- A preferred app for Gen Z self-help
- A bridge between silence and self-expression

## 9. MONETISATION / SUSTAINABILITY

To ensure *Untangle*'s long-term sustainability and scalability while remaining youth-friendly, the app will adopt a **subscription-based revenue model** with strategically tiered offerings.

The goal is to create a product that is **both emotionally impactful and commercially viable**, making it attractive to investors and scalable in the mental health tech market.

---

## Monetisation Strategy

| Phase | Strategy |
|---|---|
| **Launch (Month 1)** | **Free Trial Period** – All features open for 1 month to build trust, user engagement, and feedback. |
| **Post-Trial (Month 2+)** | **Subscription Model Begins** – Low-cost plans introduced to ensure accessibility while driving revenue. |

---

## Subscription Model

| Plan | Price (Tentative) | Includes |
|---|---|---|
| **Weekly** | ₹29 / week | Access to concern prompts, basic trackers, music packs, and vision board. |
| **Monthly** | ₹89 / month | Everything in weekly + exclusive CBT/DBT exercises, journals, mood insights. |
| **Yearly** | ₹799 / year | All features + early access to new content, premium themes, badge unlocks. |

Pricing is designed to be pocket-friendly while promoting consistent user commitment.

---

## Revenue-Generating Features

- **Dynamic Content Upgrades**
  New exercises, coping kits, themed reflections, and sound therapy tools released monthly to maintain user interest and justify subscriptions.
- **Gamified Premium Add-ons**
  Motivational themes, productivity kits, aesthetic journal covers, and avatar personalization as in-app purchases.

- **School & College Licensing**
  Institutional packages offering analytics dashboards and campus-specific versions of the app with mental health trend reports.
- **Corporate CSR Partnerships**
  Brands can sponsor free subscriptions for underprivileged users or host branded emotional health campaigns.

---

### Investor Appeal

- **Scalable Freemium Architecture**
  Designed to onboard large user bases at zero cost and gradually convert to paying customers via value-added upgrades.
- **Recurring Revenue Model**
  Subscriptions ensure predictable, recurring income — a key metric for investor confidence.
- **High Retention Design**
  Gamified streaks, rewards, and regular content drops maintain engagement, encouraging renewals and word-of-mouth growth.
- **Market Relevance**
  Emotional wellness is a rapidly growing sector, and *Untangle* caters to an underserved niche — emotionally overwhelmed teens — making it a strong candidate for EdTech + HealthTech investments.

## 10. FUTURE SCOPE, CONCLUSION & CALL TO ACTION

### Future Scope

While CBT and DBT-based approaches have existed in mental health spaces, *Untangle* emerges as one of the **first youth-focused, daily-use mental health apps in India** that is **task-driven, habit-forming, and rooted in psychology**. Its design is innovative in the way it:

- **Simplifies therapy into daily tasks**, making mental wellness actionable and sustainable for teenagers.
- **Blends technology with evidence-based methods**, offering a non-clinical, self-guided, stigma-free space.

This positions *Untangle* to evolve into:

- **India's leading teen mental health app**, adopted across schools and youth networks.
- A **trusted mental wellness companion**, beyond just schools — usable by any teen looking for emotional support.
- A **tech-enabled psychological toolkit**, enhanced with AI-based growth insights, journaling feedback, and adaptive prompts.

- A **global template for youth mental health innovation**, adaptable for different cultures and languages.

---

## Conclusion

*Untangle* bridges the gap between teenagers and mental health support by creating a platform that is **engaging, accessible, psychologically grounded, and deeply empathetic**. Its format doesn't overwhelm — instead, it integrates wellness into everyday moments.

In a digital world full of distractions, *Untangle* is a space to slow down, reflect, and heal — a **gentle intervention that meets teens where they are**.

---

## Call to Action

We invite:

- **Investors** to support a socially impactful, scalable model with clear monetization and long-term growth potential.
- **Educators and institutions** to integrate *Untangle* as part of a proactive well-being curriculum.
- **Teens** to begin their journey toward emotional clarity — one task, one check-in, one breath at a time.

*Untangle is more than a wellness app — it's a mission to create an emotionally resilient generation.*

---

## Introduction – The Importance of Mental Health

Mental health is a cornerstone of overall well-being, particularly during adolescence. This period is pivotal for emotional development, academic achievement, and social integration. However, mental health issues often go unaddressed, leading to long-term consequences.

---

## Problem – Unawareness and Mental Health Challenges

- **Lack of Awareness**: A significant gap exists in mental health literacy among adolescents. For instance, a study found that only 29.04% of adolescents could identify depression, and a mere 1.31% recognized schizophrenia/psychosis Lippincott.
- **Prevalence of Mental Health Issues**: Mental health disorders are alarmingly prevalent among adolescents. Research indicates that the prevalence rate of

psychiatric disorders in school settings is approximately 23.33%, while in community settings, it's about 6.46% BioMed Central. Additionally, studies have reported that 24% of schoolchildren exhibit signs of psychological distress, with 6% to 10% requiring immediate attention The Times of India.

- **Stigma and Help-Seeking Barriers**: Despite the high incidence of mental health issues, many adolescents do not seek help. Factors such as stigma, lack of awareness, and limited access to mental health services contribute to this reluctance.

---

## Solution – Untangle: A Teen-Centric Mental Health Companion

**Untangle** is designed to address the unique needs of adolescents by providing a relatable, engaging, and accessible platform for mental well-being:

1. **Emotion-Based Task Engine**: Teens can select their current emotional state, prompting tailored coping exercises grounded in Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT) and Dialectical Behavior Therapy (DBT).
2. **Mood Tracker and Progress Dashboard**: Users can monitor their emotional journey over time, fostering self-awareness and personal growth.
3. **Skill Development Zone**: Beyond emotional support, Untangle offers modules to enhance life skills, resilience, and personal development.
4. **Gamified Engagement**: Features such as streaks, rewards, and interactive challenges encourage consistent use and positive habit formation.
5. **Privacy and Accessibility**: The platform is designed to be user-friendly, ensuring privacy and accessibility, making it suitable for a diverse adolescent audience.

---

## Why Untangle?

- **Tailored for Teens**: Unlike generic mental health apps, Untangle is specifically crafted to resonate with adolescents, addressing their unique challenges and communication styles.
- **Integrated Approach**: It combines emotional support with skill development, offering a holistic approach to adolescent well-being.
- **Engaging and Interactive**: Through gamification and interactive features, Untangle ensures that users remain engaged and motivated to prioritize their mental health.
- **Accessible and Private**: Designed with privacy in mind, Untangle provides a safe space for teens to explore and manage their emotions without fear of judgment.

---

## Monetization Strategy

Untangle employs a freemium model to ensure accessibility while generating revenue:

- **Free Tier**: Access to basic features, including mood tracking and limited coping exercises.

- **Premium Subscription**: Unlocks advanced features such as personalized therapy modules, skill development courses, and exclusive content.
- **Institutional Partnerships**: Collaborations with schools and educational institutions to provide Untangle as part of their wellness programs.
- **Corporate Sponsorships and CSR Initiatives**: Partnering with organizations to sponsor access for underserved communities, aligning with their corporate social responsibility goals

---

## Why Untangle is Different from ChatGPT

### 1. Purpose-Built for Teens vs General AI

- **ChatGPT:** A general AI that can answer questions, give advice, or simulate conversations. It's not specifically designed for teen mental health, emotional tracking, or long-term wellness.
- **Untangle:** Designed specifically for adolescents' mental health, offering structured support, coping exercises, and self-awareness tools tailored to teen challenges.

### 2. Evidence-Based Therapeutic Tools

- **ChatGPT:** Provides general advice and information but is not a certified therapy tool.
- **Untangle:** Uses proven techniques like CBT and DBT exercises, mood tracking, and skill-building modules to actively improve emotional well-being.

### 3. Ongoing Personalization and Progress Tracking

- **ChatGPT:** Doesn't track your emotional history or growth over time. Each conversation is isolated unless logged externally.
- **Untangle:** Monitors moods, progress, and habits, helping teens see their emotional journey and identify patterns for long-term growth.

### 4. Gamified Engagement

- **ChatGPT:** Interaction is purely conversational; it doesn't motivate consistent engagement or build habits.
- **Untangle:** Uses gamification—streaks, rewards, and challenges—to keep teens engaged and consistent in practicing mental wellness.

### 5. Privacy & Safe Space

- **ChatGPT:** Conversations are stored for AI learning purposes and not tailored to privacy-safe therapy environments.
- **Untangle:** Specifically designed to provide a secure, private space for teens to explore feelings without judgment.

---

## Why Untangle is Better for Teens

- Offers **structured mental health support** rather than just casual advice.
- Provides **personalized exercises and progress tracking**, making it actionable.
- Engages teens with **interactive, gamified tools**, promoting consistency.
- Ensures **privacy and safety**, crucial for adolescent users
- ChatGPT can chat, answer, or guide, but Untangle is **a teen-focused, therapeutic, interactive platform** that actually helps
- teens develop mental resilience, emotional awareness, and life skills over time.